

A tip for open source businesses

Find a problem that needs to be fixed. Then use your expertise and domain knowledge to develop something that is useful, and stick with it—perseverance is the key.

the clients, with respect to their IT budgets and second, how established a player you are. Once you are established as a player in this segment, people start looking at you differently and things become a tad easier than before.”

“In the beginning, it was difficult for us to convince people about the advantages of open source technology, but we had to stick with it. We never thought of resorting to proprietary technology because open source technology is comparatively very mature.” Enjay uses quite a few technologies including LAMP, Java, the Linux kernel, scripts, etc.

The difficulties of finding the right talent

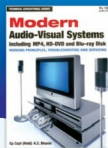
Although open source technology is quite a phenomenon, it is yet to penetrate into smaller towns. Enjay, which is based in Bhilad, a small town in Gujarat, faced this issue initially but has become an ‘employer of choice’ gradually. Parekh says, “Finding the right people was difficult, but not impossible. There is awareness and, hence, availability of people with the right skill sets now. In fact, Enjay has evolved as one of the best options for local talent here; otherwise, techies would have to go to places like Bengaluru, Pune and Mumbai for jobs. With

“It is much easier to develop on open source projects and create the value addition on them compared to developing something from scratch. For us, open source technology is a way of life. It is a well thought of decision. We analysed each aspect around the technology and then came to the conclusion that there’s nothing better than open source.”

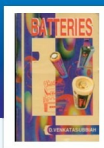
Enjay, they find jobs in the open source world, locally.”

Enjay uses unconventional methods to hire talent. The founder of the company shares, “We generally help many college students do a lot of projects. We are involved with a large number of local colleges, where we help students and faculty members make students employable. This helps us get the right candidates with the right aptitude and knowledge.”

The company generally looks to hire freshers and prefers to train them in-house. Workshops and training programmes are conducted by the company’s senior team members. The firm also seeks the help of external experts to share their knowledge with the Enjay team. **END**

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